

Sensors Are Messengers

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can describe a measurement using its quantity, value, unit and conditions.

I can distinguish a sensor reading from an interpretation or decision.

I can use repeated comparisons to investigate a measurement problem without inventing certainty.

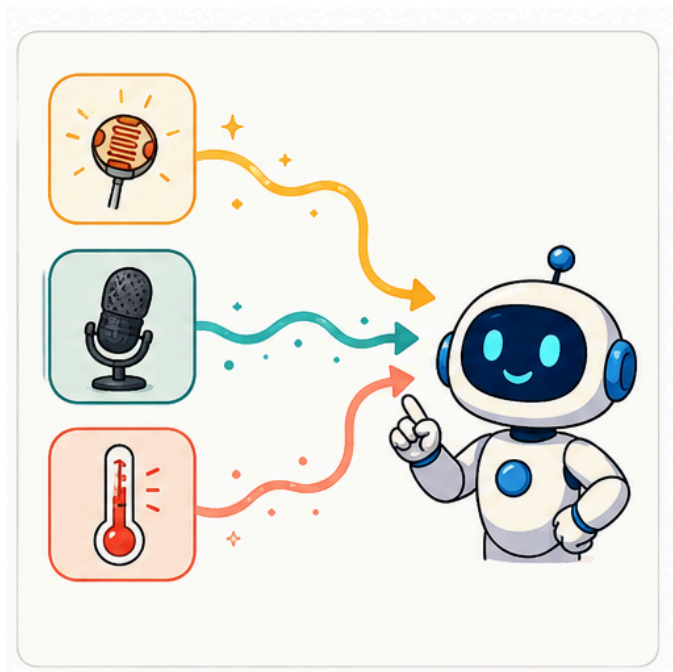
Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Input, Process, Output. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

Sensors measure signals; later processing gives those signals meaning.



LEARNING TARGET Two light sensors report 40 and 80 in different rooms. Their settings and units are unknown. Can you conclude the second room is twice as bright? Design a fair comparison without using a camera or personal data.

Learner name:

Readiness for the connected explanation

A record retains only the highest temperature of a day. Can it establish when that temperature occurred? Explain using two possible records.

This week's end goal

By the end, I can compare sensor readings while controlling where and when they are measured.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



MYSTERY A classroom weather station measures light, sound, and temperature but does not decide what those measurements mean.

What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

GOOD THINKING A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

A closer explanation

A garden display shows 24. Is that warm? We cannot interpret the number until we know what was measured and the unit. It might mean 24 degrees Celsius, 24 percent soil moisture according to a particular device, or 24 hours since watering. The screen alone does not supply the missing meaning.

A useful measurement record names the quantity, value, unit, time and relevant conditions. For air temperature, the location and exposure matter: a device in direct sunshine may warm differently from one in shade. Record the conditions rather than assuming that every nearby device measured the same situation.

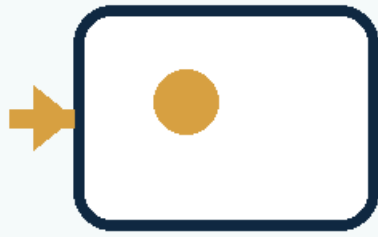
Measurement is a way of representing part of the physical world. It does not capture everything about that world. One air-temperature reading does not tell us how dry the roots are, whether a plant is diseased or whether watering is permitted.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.



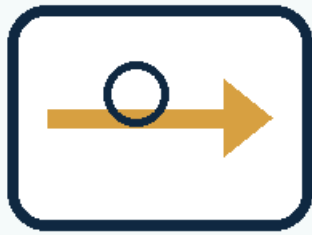
INPUT

light, sound, or heat from the environment



PROCESS

a sensor converts the signal into recorded values



OUTPUT

numbers or pixel/sound data sent to a later process

INPUT light, sound, or heat from the environment

PROCESS a sensor converts the signal into recorded values

OUTPUT numbers or pixel/sound data sent to a later process

CORE IDEA Sensors measure signals; later processing gives those signals meaning.

UNDER THE HOOD A sensor is a transducer: it converts a physical quantity into a signal a computing system can represent. Sensing and interpretation are separate. A camera measures light; an image model may later infer a label.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

A closer explanation

Three different stages in a garden system

Input · Operation · Output

Input: Physical temperature at the sensor

Operation: Sensor and measuring electronics

Output: Recorded air temperature 24 degrees C

Input: Recorded value 24 degrees C

Operation: Written rule checks whether value exceeds 28

Output: Warning is off

Input: Readings and a gardener's inspection

Operation: Gardener decides what action is appropriate

Output: An action or a decision to wait

Sensing, checking a rule and deciding what to do are separate stages. A correct rule can still receive an unsuitable measurement.

The sensor responds to a physical quantity. Electronics convert the response into a recorded value. A later program can compare the value with a threshold. Nothing about this path requires us to claim that the sensor understands plant health.

The rule uses exceeds 28, so a reading of exactly 28 does not trigger it. At 29 it does. This boundary is a property of the written rule; it is separate from the question of whether the measuring device is accurate enough for the intended purpose.

The sensor measures. The rule decides.

Light scale: 0 darker, 100 brighter. Written rule: reading below 30 → lamp ON; otherwise OFF. Trace 29 → ON and 30 → OFF. Use the HTML slider to investigate.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

4. Compare the cases

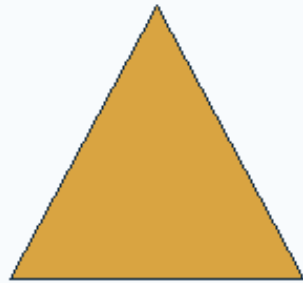
PICTURE GALLERY

Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



Camera



Microphone



Thermometer



Button

CASE 1 — Camera Clue: light becomes pixel values. Meaning: measurement, not meaning.

CASE 2 — Microphone Clue: air-pressure changes become samples. Meaning: measurement, not understanding.

CASE 3 — Thermometer Clue: heat becomes a temperature number. Meaning: measurement, not a weather decision.

CASE 4 — Button Clue: a press becomes an on/off value. Meaning: a human event becomes data.

BOUNDARY Do not say a sensor sees, hears, or understands. It measures and sends a representation.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Move only B into brighter light.

Prediction: The next gap could change for reasons other than a difference in device accuracy.

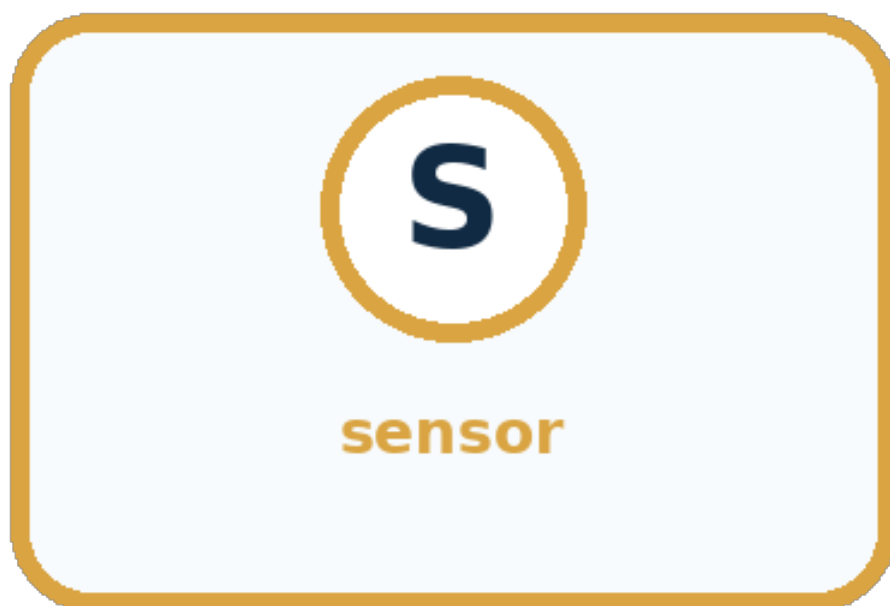
Reason: The comparison now changes location as well as device; there is no supplied reading from the new location.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY

Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





signal



measurement



Word · Meaning · My example

Word: sensor

Meaning: device that measures a physical signal

My example: _____

Word: signal

Meaning: a changing quantity that can be measured

My example: _____

Word: measurement

Meaning: a recorded value describing part of a signal

My example: _____

Word: data

Meaning: represented information available for processing

My example: _____

Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR The camera knows there is a cat.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Unit

Meaning: An agreed amount used to express a quantity, such as a second or a degree Celsius

Word: Variation

Meaning: Differences among readings or observations

Word: Calibration

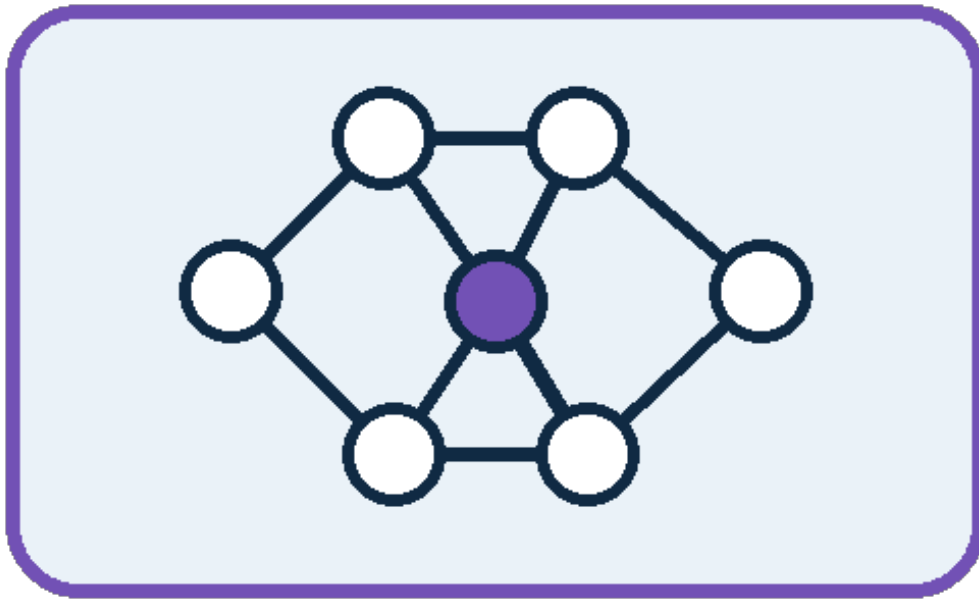
Meaning: Checking and, when appropriate, adjusting a measuring system against a reference

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EXAMPLE

Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



CASE A classroom weather station measures light, sound, and temperature but does not decide what those measurements mean.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE light, sound, or heat from the environment

STEP 2 — TRACE a sensor converts the signal into recorded values

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE numbers or pixel/sound data sent to a later process

MODEL REASONING 820 could be a light measurement, 24 C comes from a temperature sensor, and changing sound values come from a microphone. The numbers alone do not prove whether the plant needs water or whether a voice was present; later processing must interpret them.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM Do not say a sensor sees, hears, or understands. It measures and sends a representation.

What new evidence could change this answer?

A closer explanation

Two devices are placed side by side in a shaded room and allowed to settle. At three agreed times, device A reads 20, 21 and 20 degrees C; device B reads 22, 23 and 22 degrees C. B is 2 degrees higher on every comparison. That pattern is evidence of a consistent difference under these test conditions.

Time · A in degrees C · B in degrees C · B minus A

Time: 10:00

A in degrees C: 20

B in degrees C: 22

B minus A: 2

Time: 10:05

A in degrees C: 21

B in degrees C: 23

B minus A: 2

Time: 10:10

A in degrees C: 20

B in degrees C: 22

B minus A: 2

We cannot conclude from agreement patterns alone that A is correct and B is wrong. A suitable checked reference can help investigate. We also need to consider whether the devices have different response times, resolutions or placement. Three comparisons in one room do not prove performance in every temperature range.

Calibration is a reference check, sometimes followed by an adjustment. Do not simply subtract 2 from every future B reading because these three pairs happened to differ by 2. A correction needs support over the conditions where it will be used.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Sensors Are Messengers

Two fictional light sensors disagree in a classroom. Compare them fairly rather than declaring one broken.

The facts we will use

On the same shelf, simultaneous readings are A: 40,50,60 and B: 45,55,65 in declared toy light units.

Neither device has been compared with a trusted reference.

Simultaneous light readings

	Sensor A	Sensor B	B minus A
Time 1	40	45	5
Time 2	50	55	5
Time 3	60	65	5

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

Sensors Are Messengers

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Same shelf

Place both devices together and allow them to settle.



2. Paired readings

Record three matching times: (40,45), (50,55), (60,65).



3. Compare gaps

B minus A is 5, 5 and 5 units.



4. Check a reference

A trusted reference is needed to decide which reading is closer.

CHANGE ONE THING

Move only B into brighter light.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Same shelf

What happens and why: Place both devices together and allow them to settle.

Step: 2. Paired readings

What happens and why: Record three matching times: (40,45), (50,55), (60,65).

Step: 3. Compare gaps

What happens and why: B minus A is 5, 5 and 5 units.

Step: 4. Check a reference

What happens and why: A trusted reference is needed to decide which reading is closer.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

A repeated difference of 5 supports investigating an offset between devices. Matching time and location removes two obvious comparison problems. It does not show which device is correct: both could have errors. Preserve paired readings instead of adjusting them silently.

What this example does not establish

Three pairs do not prove an offset holds at every light level, nor identify the accurate device.

7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

Case · Evidence · What it shows

Case: Camera

Evidence: light becomes pixel values

What it shows: measurement, not meaning

Case: Microphone

Evidence: air-pressure changes become samples

What it shows: measurement, not understanding

Case: Thermometer

Evidence: heat becomes a temperature number

What it shows: measurement, not a weather decision

Case: Button

Evidence: a press becomes an on/off value

What it shows: a human event becomes data

Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A The camera knows there is a cat.

Repair:

CLAIM B More sensors always make a system better.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim _____ because the evidence shows _____. The process is _____. One limit is _____.

A closer explanation

A warning based on one temperature reading can mean the recorded value crossed a threshold. It cannot automatically mean a plant needs water. That broader claim would need different evidence. When a system makes a surprising decision, check the units, time, location, measurement and rule in order.

For classroom investigations, use teacher-provided records or ordinary safe room conditions. The reasoning task does not require heating devices, opening electronics or testing people. A clear paper investigation can reveal the same distinction between a reading and an interpretation.

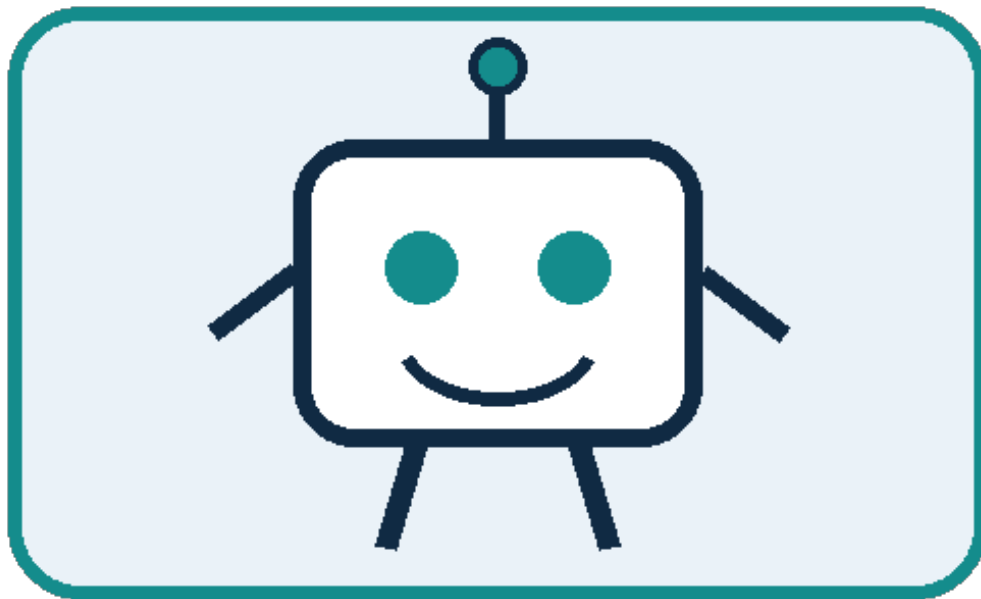
A display says 30 without a unit. State two questions needed before using it in a temperature-warning rule

8. Practise together

GUIDED PRACTICE

Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: Sensors measure signals; later processing gives those signals meaning.

Use a fresh example to explain sensor.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: More sensors always make a system better.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

PARTNER CHECK Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

A closer explanation

Suppose one classroom device reports 27 degrees C near a sunny window and another reports 22 degrees C in shade. The five-degree difference may reflect the locations. Calling one device faulty skips an alternative explanation. First write a prediction: if location explains the difference, placing both devices together after they settle should reduce it.

A fair comparison changes the suspected factor while keeping other relevant conditions as similar as practical. Record what was changed and what remained uncertain. Repeated results can strengthen or weaken an explanation, but a short classroom test is not a guarantee about all future measurements.

Two devices disagree near a window and a shaded wall. Describe a comparison that helps

separate location from device differences

Practise with less help: Trace a boundary

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Sensors and measurement”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Sensors and measurement. Proposed explanation: “The more stable device must be accurate”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Why can we calculate the earlier gap but not predict an exact new B reading?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

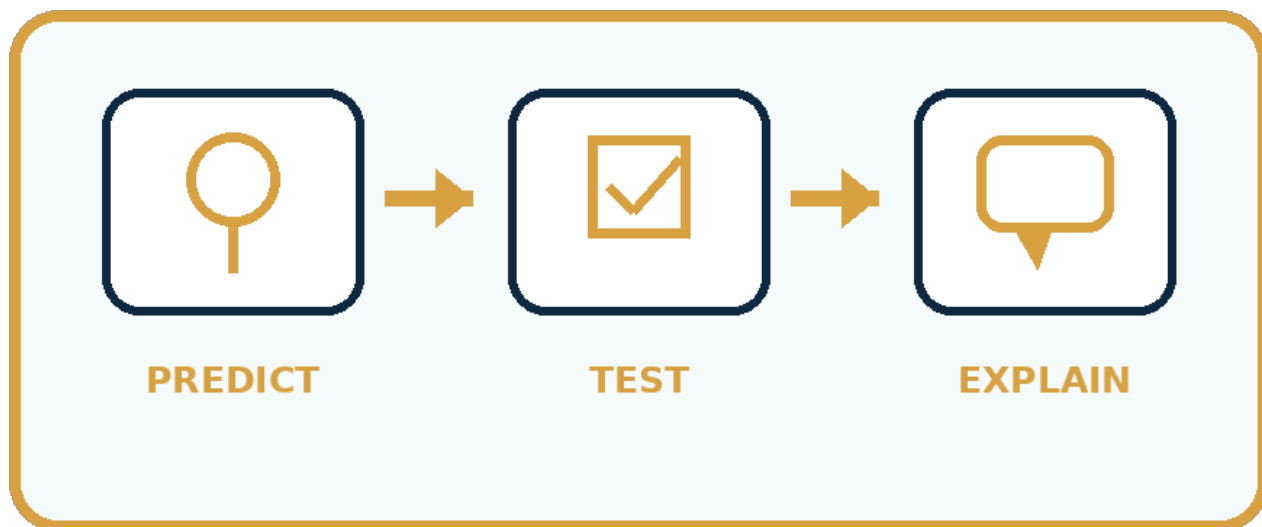
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

Signal Messenger Match

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Match camera, microphone, and temperature sensors to data.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

Case: Normal

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

Case: Edge

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Plan → try → check

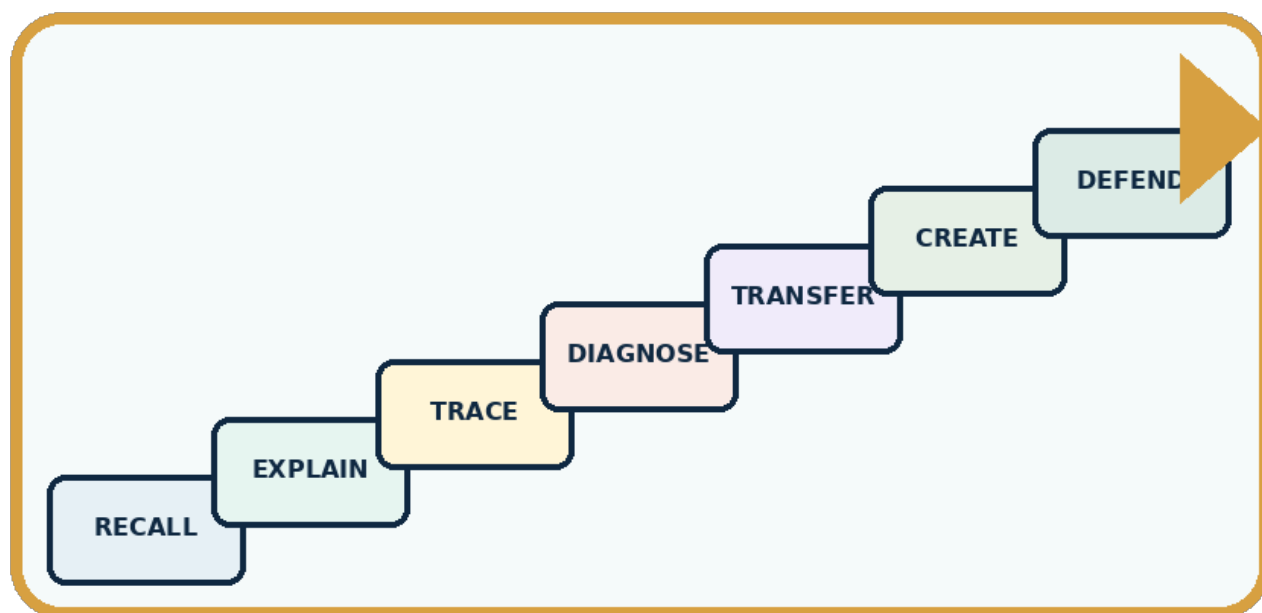
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define sensor.

EXPLAIN Sensors measure signals; later processing gives those signals meaning.

TRACE Show the input, process, and output.

DIAGNOSE Repair: The camera knows there is a cat.

TRANSFER Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

CREATE Design one revealing test.

DEFEND Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

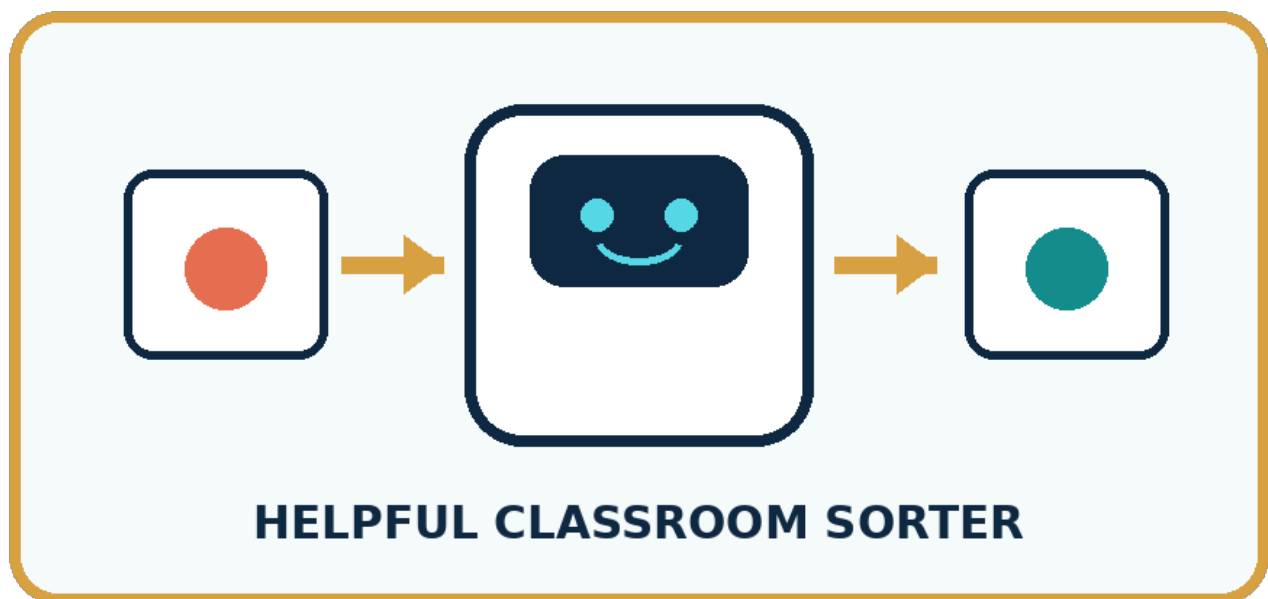
RETRY RULE A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

11. Connect your project

PROJECT

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Mark which sensor, if any, would collect each Classroom Sorter input; prefer direct human entry when a sensor is unnecessary.

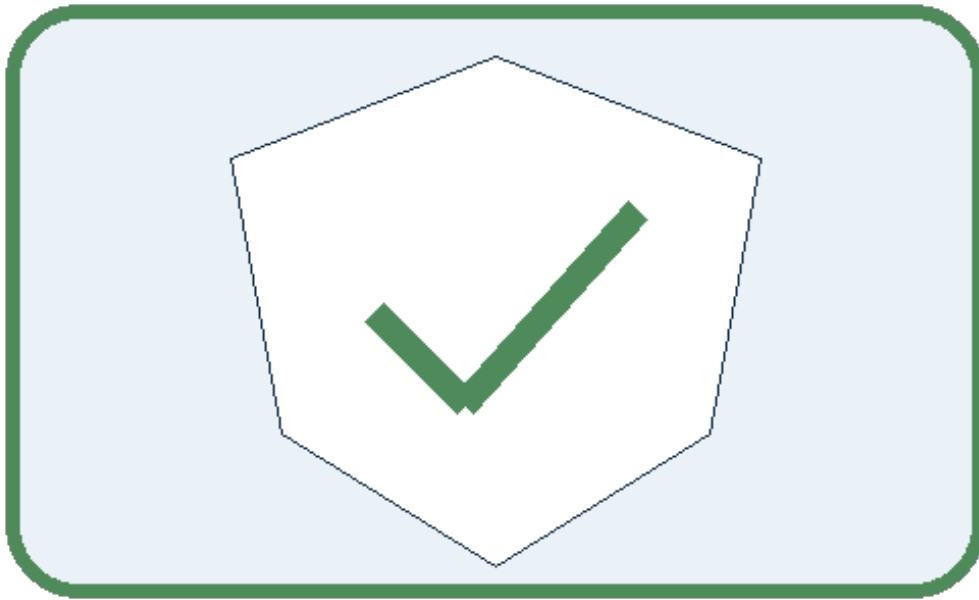
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Do not say a sensor sees, hears, or understands. It measures and sends a representation.

My project decision:

Evidence for your project

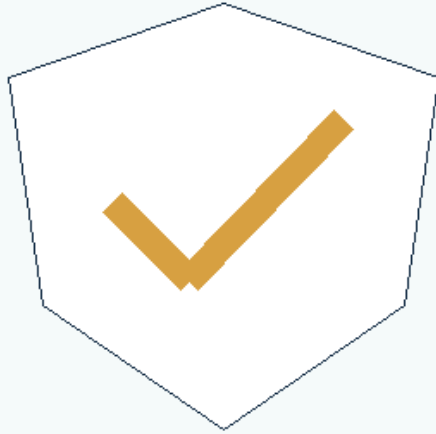
Save sorter measurements with device, location and time so unusual inputs can be checked before decisions.

12. Show what you know

MASTERY

Fresh-Case Independent Proof

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

REQUIRED PROOF A plant station reports 820, 24 C, and a sequence of sound values. Identify each likely sensor, its signal, and what remains unknown.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

SELF-CHECK 820 could be a light measurement, 24 C comes from a temperature sensor, and changing sound values come from a microphone. The numbers alone do not prove whether the plant needs water or whether a voice was present; later processing must interpret them.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

NEXT BRIDGE Carry today's evidence habit into: Rules or Learned Patterns?.

13. Study a complete case

Week 3 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

A light sensor reads 15 in a cupboard and 90 near a window. A microphone records a clap.

The question

Which measures a light-related signal? Can either directly measure happiness?

Worked explanation

The light sensor measures light; the microphone measures sound. Neither directly measures feelings. Units and calibration matter when comparing devices.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

Two light readings, one sensor

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Cupboard

Value or result: 15

Evidence or stage: Window

Value or result: 90

A light sensor reads 15 in a cupboard and 90 near a window. A microphone records a clap.

Which measures a light-related signal? Can either directly measure happiness?

The light sensor measures light; the microphone measures sound. Neither directly measures feelings. Units and calibration matter when comparing devices.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Investigate a new measurement dispute

A classroom sound display near a speaker reads higher than one near the door. A student declares the door device broken. Propose a safe comparison using normal classroom sound. Predict one result consistent with location explaining the difference and one result that would leave a device difference worth investigating.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 3 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

A station reports light level 18 and temperature 22 degrees C. Which sensor produced each reading? Can either reading alone tell whether a child feels comfortable? Explain.

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Mark which sensor, if any, would collect each Classroom Sorter input; prefer direct human entry when a sensor is unnecessary.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

Two light sensors report 40 and 80 in different rooms. Their settings and units are unknown. Can you conclude the second room is twice as bright? Design a fair comparison without using a camera or personal data.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.